Eulalie Saïsset

PhD Student · Sciences Po · CIRED

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Affiliations & institutions

Sciences Po | Department of Economics & CRIS — *November 2023 -*

CIRED — *November 2023 -*

French Ministry of Ecological Transition | DGALN (PhD funding) — *November 2023 -*

Research interests

- Biodiversity Economics
- Urban Economics
- Public Economics
- Inequalities

Education

Sciences Po & CIRED — *Paris*

PhD in Economics — *November 2023 - present*

- Title: *A Fair Share of Land: No Net Land Take and the Quest for Equity in Soil Conservation*
- Co-directors: Lucas Chancel (Associate Professor, Sciences Po & Co-Director, World Inequality Lab, Paris School of Economics) & Harold Levrel (Professor, Muséum National d'Histoire Naturelle (CESCO) & Researcher, CIRED)

Paris School of Economics — *Paris*

Masters in Economics of Public Policies & Development — *Sept. 2020 - June 2022*

- Classes include: Econometrics, Measurement of Policy Outcomes, Climate Geopolitics, Natural Resources, Inequalities, Public Policies

Mines Paris PSL — *Paris*

Masters in Engineering — *Sept. 2017 - Sept. 2021*

- Classes include: Applied Mathematics & Physics, Industrial Organisation, Energy Transition, Law, Computer Science
- Major in Sociology (Science and Technology Studies)

Lycée Louis Le Grand — *Paris*

Classe préparatoire aux grandes écoles - MPSI/PSI* — *Sept. 2015 - July 2017*

References

Lucas Chancel
Associate Professor of Economics
Sciences Po
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Thomas Piketty
Professor of Economics
EHESS & Paris School of Economics
thomas.piketty@psemail.eu

Harold Levrel
Professor of Ecological Economics
Muséum National d'Histoire Naturelle (CESCO)
harold.Levrel@mnhn.fr

Publications & outreach

Peer-reviewed research papers

Semieniuk, G., Chancel, L., Saïsset, E., Holden, P. B., Mercure, J.-F., Edwards, N. R. (2023). Potential pension fund losses should not deter high-income countries from bold climate action. *Joule*, 7(7), 1383-1387.

Stokenberga, A., Saïsset, E., Kerzhner, T., Espinet Alegre, X. (2024). Connecting through public transport: Accessibility to health and education in major African cities. *Area Development and Policy*, 0(0), 1-18.

Other publications

Mini, C., Saïsset, E. (2021). Ajustement carbone aux frontières. L'Europe à l'heure des choix. *La Fabrique de l'industrie*. Presse des Mines.

Mini, C., Saïsset, E. (2021). Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism. Friend or foe of the European Industry? *La Fabrique de l'industrie.*

World Bank. (2021). Connectivity for Human Capital: Realizing the Right to Education and Healthcare through Improved Public Transport in African Cities. *Mobility and Transport Connectivity*. © World Bank.

Broader outreach

Saïsset, E., Boyer, C. (2025). Accounting for net-zero cities: carbon and soil. *Villes sobres : vers quelles transitions urbaines*. Sciences Po.

Saïsset, E. (2025). A taxing dilemma: Land take, fiscal revenues and the redistribution puzzle. *Villes sobres : vers quelles transitions urbaines*. Sciences Po.

Saïsset, E., Bas, A. (2023). Mécanisme d'Ajustement Carbone aux Frontières. Quels enjeux pour les entreprises ? *Avis d'expert.* I Care

Mini, C., Binois, E., Saïsset, E. (2021). Les ZFE de la loi Climat, une occasion de repenser et d'accélérer la mobilité électrique *Le blog de la Fabrique de l'industrie.* Alternatives Economiques

Saïsset, E., Fouchard, B., Stokenberga, A. (2020). Access Granted: Unlocking Opportunities through Better Urban Transport. *Transport for Development*. World Bank Blogs.

Ongoing research

Working papers

Land-use Litigation and the Microgeography of NIMBYism (with François Lafont).

As cities grow, building in already populated areas becomes central to housing affordability and land preservation, but also triggers not-in-my-backyard (NIMBY) opposition. To measure it, we construct a dataset from judicial archives covering all construction and land-use litigation in France since 2005. Using an LLM, we extract with high accuracy rich contextual information from over 200,000 court decisions. We document that NIMBY opposition primarily takes the form of individuals challenging housing permits, disproportionately targeting multi-family housing. Consistent with a simple model in which neighbors litigate to protect their property values, challenges to approved housing concentrate in dense and expensive areas. Second-home owners also account for a significant share of litigation, especially in high-end tourist locations. In low-density areas, by contrast, litigation more often comes from owners of undeveloped land appealing permit denials to preserve their building rights.

A Taxing Dilemma: Land Take, Fiscal Revenues and Municipal Budgets.

Urban expansion drives biodiversity loss and increases travel costs without effectively boosting housing production, necessitating land use policies that limit development. Simultaneously, land-related tax revenues constitute a significant portion of municipal budgets and potential incentives for local authorities to develop land precisely when land value increases: a taxing dilemma between preserving soils and raising municipal revenues. Using a panel database of France's main land-related taxes and exploiting quasi-experimental variation in toxic loan exposure, we analyse how financial constraints affect land take. Results reveal nuanced responses: only municipalities severely affected by the debt shock exhibit an increase in land take. This effect primarily reflects commercial rather than residential development, accompanied by reduced densification. Municipalities strategically adjust fiscal policy by moderately increasing property taxes (their highest revenue-generating instrument). Under fiscal competition where policy options are constrained, land take increases substantially, highlighting environmental risks. These findings challenge the presumed tradeoff between local fiscal revenues and land conservation, suggesting that financial constraints typically promote restrained land use except under severe fiscal stress with limited alternatives. This paper demonstrates the necessity of considering tax system complexity regarding both incentives and environmental impact when designing policy.

Work in progress

Distributional Analysis of Land Take: Human and Ecological Impacts in France (with Harold Levrel).

In France, land take disproportionately affects agricultural land, with land prices surging up to 65 times upon reclassification as buildable. This process not only threatens biodiversity but also exacerbates socio-economic inequalities, as wealth disparities increasingly limit access to homeownership, especially for younger generations. This research project investigates the relationship between land tenure inequalities and artificialization, focusing on the distribution of ownership and the beneficiaries of associated land rents. By constructing a comprehensive national database of real estate property, including socio-economic characteristics of owners, we analyze ownership concentration before and after land take.

Presentations

Conference and seminar presentations

Forthcoming

2026 ***Inequality and the Environment Symposium***, Paris, France
Beyond Land Use conference, Paris, France
World Inequality Conference, Paris, France
French Political Economy Association, Paris, France
Climate Economics Chair Seminar, Paris, France
CRIS Seminar, Paris, France

2025 **SIEP Conference**, Naples, Italy
ISEE Conference, Oslo, Norway
LSE Department of Geography and Environment, Environmental Economics Seminar, London, UK
Econom'IA workshop, Nanterre, France

2024 **World Inequality Lab, Annual retreat**, Paris, France

Invited talks

2025 **Journée d'étude de l'Institut de la Transition Foncière**, Paris, France

2024 **Rencontres de la Transition Industrielle**, ADEME, Angers, France

2021 **European carbon pricing policies**, One-day training module for Mines Paris master students, Paris, France

Teaching and awareness-raising experience

Since 2024 **Lecturer (24h)**, Ecological Accounting for Net-Zero Cities : Carbon and Soil cross-case analysis
Urban Governance, Policy and Planning master's program, Urban School, Sciences Po

Fall 2024 **Lecturer (48h)**, Data & Statistics
Masters in International Business and Sustainability, Sciences Po

2022 - 2023 **Trainer**, Training on environmental sustainability
Teaching company directors, French administrative staff and environmental consultants on transition challenges (carbon pricing, natural resources, carbon footprint, industrial decarbonation)

2022 **Trainer**, La Fresque de la finance
Development and roll-out

2021 - now **Trainer**, La Fresque du climat
Facilitator in French and English; roll-out at the Paris School of Economics

2018 - 2019 **Teaching Assistant (120h)**, Engineering Sciences
Preparation of students of PCSI class for the oral examinations of the *grandes écoles*, Lycée Saint-Louis

Awards, fellowships & grants

2026	**Young researcher programme**, LIEPP (Sciences Po)	*€2,000*
2025	**Conference participation grant**, ADRES	*€500*
2024	**Palladio Grant**, Palladio Fondation	*€10,000*
2024	**GO LSE exchange programme**, London School of Economics & Sciences Po	*€4,500*
2023	**COFRA funding**, Ministère de la Transition Ecologique et de la Cohésion des Territoires	*PhD funding*

Professional experience

I Care & Consult *Paris*

Environmental Economics Consultant *Feb. 2022 - Nov. 2023*

- Strategic support for public (local authorities, administration, government agencies) and private players in the transition
- Topics: decarbonation of industry, criticality of raw materials, carbon pricing, transition costs
- Methodological development on key challenges: reliance on critical natural resources, technology abatement costs, internal carbon pricing, multi-sector forecasting exercises

La Fabrique de l'industrie *Paris*

Intern *Jan. 2021 - Aug. 2021*

- Carbon Border Adjustment Mecanism: mapping of industrial stakeholders' positions (using qualitative and quantitative tools)

World Bank, Transport Global Practice *Washington, DC*

Transport Analyst for the Africa Region *Aug. 2019 - Aug. 2020*

- Financing transport projects in Africa (urban mobility, multimodal corridors) and participation in field missions
- Modelling of transport networks and accessibility studies using urban planning tools
- Economic evaluation and technical design of projects, examination of environmental and social aspects

Research experience & visiting

London School of Economics *London*

Department of Geography and Environment *Jan. 2025 - May 2025*

- Visiting research student

Paris School of Economics *Paris*

Advisor: Lucas Chancel; Referee: Thomas Piketty *Sept. 2021 - June 2022*

- Master thesis: 'The Carbon Bubble: how big is it and who owns it? Methods and estimates for Europe' on the distributional impact of fossil fuel assets stranding

Centre de Sociologie de l'Innovation (CSI), Mines Paris *Paris*

Co-Advisors: Brice Laurent & Liliana Doganova *Feb. 2019 - Apr. 2019*

- Researched mineral resource development in French Guiana to analyze key territorial challenges: gold mining, economic development, conservation of the environment, land-use planning and protecting indigenous peoples

Centre Automatique et Systèmes, Mines Paris *Paris*

Advisor: Florent Di Meglio *Sep. 2018 - Apr. 2019*

- Research internship in applied mathematics focused on the design of an observer for a Rijke tube with heat source: theoretical study of the system's thermo-acoustics and algorithmic resolution

Service to the profession

Seminar, workshop & conference organisation

2025-2026 **Parisian Ecological Economics monthly seminar**, CIRCEE network
2025-2026 **Weekly PhD Seminar**, CIRED
2022 **Workshop in Climate in Biodiversity**, PSE

Peer review

Italian Society of Public Economics (SIEP), Annual conference, 2025
European Finance Association, Annual conference, 2025

Mentoring

2025 **Cheikh Niang**, Internship supervision (6 months), Ministère de la Transition Ecologique
2024-2025 **Elodie Flament**, Internship supervision (5 months), Ministère de la Transition Ecologique

Outreach

Created a multi-level classroom challenge (primary school to high school) on land take, as part of an AFPER program promoting inquiry-based science education (Spring 2025)

Technical skills & languages

- **Computer Skills:** R, Python, Java, Excel, ArcGIS, QGIS, LaTeX, Notion
- **Languages:** French (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate), Spanish (notions)
- **Other trainings:** Carbon footprint official training (Association Bilan Carbone), Gender equality in the workplace (Companieros)